

TARANTULA

The Hero with a sting

A criminal used the name Tarantula during the days of the Old West, but the first modern Tarantula, Anton Miguel Rodriguez, was a brutal revolutionary from the small, South American country of Delvadia. Government officials gave him his powers with a variant of the super-soldier formula, intending to make him a national symbol, like CAPTAIN AMERICA.

Delvadian leaders made the Tarantula a national symbol during a time of uprising.



FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Maria Vasquez

OCCUPATION

Hero for hire

BASE

New York

HEIGHT Unrevealed

WEIGHT Unrevealed

EYES Green

HAIR Black with red streak

FIRST APPEARANCE

Heroes For Hire #1 (August 2006)

TARANTULA

POWERS

Martial arts and knife fighting expert. Spiked blades in the wrists and toes of her costume.

KILLER FOR HIRE

Instead, he became a professional criminal and assassin. In New York, where he hijacked a boat on the Hudson River, SPIDER-MAN and the PUNISHER thwarted his plans. He later mutated into a humanoid spider due to treatments from Roxxon Oil, and he killed himself in a police standoff. His daughter donned the Tarantula costume and teamed up with the daughter of BATROC THE LEAPER before dying at the hands of the TASKMASTER.

Enhanced reflexes and military training allow the Tarantula to make surgical stabs with his venomous boot-spikes.



Rodriguez voluntarily served the Delvadian government, grateful for a chance to fight.

THE EXILE

Captain Luis Alvarez of Delvadia became the second official Tarantula. On a mission to the US to execute Delvadian refugees, he battled Spider-Man and lost. Exiled from his country, Alvarez died when the armed vigilante team the Jury executed him.

The latest Tarantula worked as part of the Heroes For Hire when Misty Knight and Colleen Wing formed a new line-up of the team.



FEMME FATALE

During the CIVIL WAR (see pp. 84-5), a new Tarantula joined the Heroes for Hire. Maria Vasquez had abilities and weapons similar to those of her predecessors, but no other connection. She hoped to avenge her sister, who died when NITRO blew up in Stamford, Connecticut. After WORLD WAR HULK, she nearly died when her teammate Humbug offered her to No-Name, the BROOD member of HULK's WARBOUND, but SHANG-CHI saved her. **DW, MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *Amazing Spider-Man* #134

First appearance of the original Tarantula.

• *Heroes for Hire* #1

Maria Vasquez appears for the first time.

• *Heroes for Hire* #15

Maria Vasquez is left in a coma as the team go their separate ways.

